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July 8, 1964

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PIKE POLE, (WOOD)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20407, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. Pike poles covered by this specification are long, wood-handled tools for use in erecting utility poles.

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and dimensions. Pike poles shall be of one type with handle dimensions as specified in table I (see 6.1):

Table I. - Dimensions.

Handle	
Length	Diameter (at thickest portion) (minimum)
Feet	Inches
8	1-5/8
10	2-1/2
12	2-1/2
14	2-1/2
16	2-1/2
18	2-1/2
20	2-1/2

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation to bid, or request for proposal, form a part of this specification:

Federal Standards:
Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 5120

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Military Specifications:
MIL-H-15424 - Hand Tools; Packaging of.

Military Standards:
MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Components. The pike pole shall consist of a long handle fitted on one end with a steel ferrule and a pike-shaped head.

3.2 Handle. The handle shall be of fir or ash. Fir shall be "virgin growth" with straight, close grain, having not less than 8 nor more than 22 growth rings per inch. Defects shall be limited to small burls, tight knots less than 1/4-inch diameter, and not loose or projecting through to the opposite surface. Ash, when used, shall be white "second growth" straight-grained and of adequate density to provide handles with good serviceability. The number of permissible defects shall be not more than two for each 18 inches of handle length or fraction thereof, with defects at least six inches apart. Handle shall be properly formed and shaped to fit the pike and have sufficient rigidity and strength for pole erection.

3.2.1 Moisture content. Moisture content of the wood shall not exceed 18 percent.

3.3 Ferrule. A ferrule made of drawn steel shall be driven over the pike end of the handle. A rivet shall run completely through the ferrule, the handle, and the tang of the pike for secure attachment of parts. Rivet holes shall be accurately punched or drilled and shall have all burrs removed. Rivet heads shall be countersunk or flattened and shall completely fill the holes.

3.4 Head. Pike pole head shall be of tempered forged steel, one-piece construction, consisting of a straight spike-shaped point and a threaded tang for screwing into the handle. The tang shall be of sufficient length to provide a sturdy and rigid connection within the handle when properly assembled. After the tang is embedded in the handle, the pike head shall project a minimum of 4 inches. At the option of the contractor, pike point may be plain, threaded, or twisted.

3.5 Guard. Pike head shall be furnished with a guard such as a sleeve, sheath or other device to provide protection from the sharp, projecting point when the tool is not in use.

3.6 Finish. The tool shall be treated and painted in accordance with the manufacturer's best standard practice, except that handles shall be finished by sanding and waxing.

3.7 Identification marking. The pike poles shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name, or with a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.8 Assembly. Pike pole heads shall not become loose nor pull free of the handles when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.9 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be of the highest grade throughout in accordance with good commercial practice.

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4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 *Responsibility for inspection.* Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. *Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall* be performed in accordance with provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 End product inspection. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated pike pole. A lot shall consist of tools of one length offered for acceptance at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling for visual examination. Sampling for visual examination shall have an inspection level of II with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per 100 units.

4.2.3 Sampling for dimensional examination and tests. The inspection level for dimensional examination and tests shall be level S-3 with an AQL of 2.5 defects per 100 units.

4.3 Inspection of pike poles.

4.3.1 Visual examination. Each sample pike pole shall be visually examined for defects in material and workmanship. Any deviation from requirements specified herein shall be considered a defect.

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. Each sample pike pole shall be examined for conformance with dimensional requirements specified herein. Any deviation shall be considered a defect.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Pull test. The pike pole head shall be securely clamped in a vise. A load of 100 pounds shall be applied to the handle in the opposite direction of the head for 5 minutes. Loosening or failure of the head, ferrule, or rivet shall each be cause for rejection.

4.4.2 Moisture content. *Each sample pike handle shall be tested to verify compliance with* the moisture content requirements of 3.2.1. An electrical moisture meter or other equally suitable method shall be used to determine moisture content. Any handle in the sample having moisture content in excess of 18 percent shall be rejected.

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery. Inspection to determine compliance with preparation for delivery requirements shall be accomplished in accordance with MIL-H-15424.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY
(Civil agencies should refer to Fed. Std. No. 102 for definitions and application of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1 Cleaning, preservation and packaging.

5.1.1 Level A. Level A cleaning, preservation, and packaging shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.1.2 Level C. Preservation and packaging which will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration, and damage during shipment from supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. (vendor to user)

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5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A. Level A packing shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.2 Level B. Level B packing shall be in accordance with level B of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.3 Level C. Packing which will afford protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.1), shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.1), interior and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Length pike pole required (see table I).
(c) Levels of preservation, packaging and packing required (see section 5).
(d) Special marking, if required (see 5.3).

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